

## Chapter 145-1

That evening, Liang Shi went to pick up Xu Qingzhu from work, only to discover that she had left the company to attend a business dinner.

Liang Shi waited downstairs at the company for a long time. She called Xu Qingzhu repeatedly but no one answered, so she called her secretary instead.

Only then did the secretary tell her the location.

The restaurant for the dinner was the same place where Liang Shi had first met Gu Yixue.

She quickly drove there.

Liang Shi sat in the car. The car lights were dim yellow, and the light was somewhat dark.

Outside, the cold wind blew whistling past, while the warm air inside the car made the cramped space feel cozy.

Liang Shi lowered her head to check her phone—the messages she had sent to Xu Qingzhu earlier still hadn't received a response.

When Liang Shi messaged Xu Qingzhu's secretary again, there was no reply either.

She was probably busy.

She kept waiting downstairs until nearly ten o'clock before she finally saw Xu Qingzhu's figure.

A group of people walked out of the building. Xu Qingzhu was dressed thinly, and the wind blew her loose clothing around chaotically. Xu Qingzhu waved goodbye to the others, standing somewhat unsteadily, yet forcing herself to remain composed so that others wouldn't easily notice.

After those people left, only Xu Qingzhu and her secretary remained.

Xu Qingzhu immediately put away all her smiles.

While Xu Qingzhu was talking to her secretary, Liang Shi drove the car over and stopped in front of her.

The car window slowly rolled down, and their eyes met.

Xu Qingzhu was surprised: "Why did you come?"

Liang Shi said gently: "To take you home."

It was as if the argument-like quarrel at noon had never happened.

Perhaps because of the cold wind, Liang Shi's voice carried a hint of coldness. She looked at Xu Qingzhu: "Aren't you cold?"

Xu Qingzhu shivered right on cue, goosebumps rising on the tender white skin of her neck.

She nodded: "I am cold."

After saying this, she looked at Liang Shi with a slightly aggrieved expression: "Aren't you going to come down?"

Liang Shi's hand had already fallen on the car door handle, but after hesitating, she stopped: "You get in the car."

Xu Qingzhu didn't speak, just stared at her unblinkingly.

As if Liang Shi had said something unbelievable.

In truth, no matter how good-tempered a person was, if they were suddenly stood up and then waited like a fool in the car for three hours, they wouldn't be very patient and would be particularly irritated.

During those three hours, Liang Shi's thoughts had gone from: Is she angry? — Should I have said more? — Is she giving me the cold shoulder? — We really need to communicate properly — I don't want to wait anymore — Maybe I should just give her some space and time — What exactly went wrong? — How should I say it?

For nearly three hours, Liang Shi hadn't done anything.

All her time had been spent on these thoughts.

Yet she still couldn't figure it out.

It was like a tangled mess of threads. Liang Shi couldn't find where the end was; she could only face this tangled mess helplessly.

From initially being eager to untangle it to later losing all interest, even wanting to just give up.

So naturally, when she saw Xu Qingzhu, she couldn't act the same as before.

What had happened at noon had also left a knot in her heart. She didn't know what she needed to do to make Xu Qingzhu believe her.

It was clearly so obvious.

And besides, those questions didn't really seem to have much meaning.

It's not like saying "I love you" ten thousand times verbally meant you truly loved someone.

You had to look at what a person actually did.

Moreover, Liang Shi had said those words during those moments of deep emotion.

That was the most sincere expression.

She didn't know what else Xu Qingzhu wanted.

The frustration of not being able to figure things out, combined with the exhaustion of waiting—after wasting time, a person always became particularly cold.

So Liang Shi's voice unconsciously turned cold.

But when she met Xu Qingzhu's pitiful gaze, Liang Shi pressed her lips together.

After struggling internally, she still pushed open the car door and got out.

The cold winter wind blew mercilessly against her, making her instantly alert.

Yet she only looked at Xu Qingzhu.

Their eyes met.

Xu Qingzhu took a step forward toward her, wrapped her arms around her waist, and buried her head in the crook of her shoulder.